
Omar Khan

UX Researcher | Mixed-Methods | Accessibility & Human-Centered AI

✉ omark807@gmail.com | 🏠 https://omarkhan83.com | in omark807 | 📍 Champaign, IL

Summary

Mixed-methods UX researcher passionate about storytelling through data: analyzing national surveys of 1,700+ participants and leading deep co-design engagements with blind and low-vision users. I specialize in accessibility and human-centered AI, translating findings into design and remediation decisions that product and engineering teams act on. Lead author on several published works at ACM SIGCHI and ASSETS, contributor to national public reports, and commercial accessibility practice across U.S., Canadian, and U.K. regulatory contexts.

Education

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

Ph.D., Computer Science (Human-Computer Interaction)

Expected May 2028

- Advisor: Dr. JooYoung Seo. Certificate in Information Accessibility Design and Policy.

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

B.S., Computer Science + Crop Sciences

2021

Experience

Fable

Remote

Accessibility Consultant (Contract)

09/2025 – Present

- Conducted **200+** moderated accessibility evaluations, including user interviews, prototype reviews, and assistive technology compatibility testing, for enterprise clients across e-commerce, health, and technology for accessible and inclusive online experiences
- Auditing against **WCAG 2.2 AA** within ADA/Section 508, Accessible Canada Act, and European Accessibility Act requirements; delivering severity-ranked remediation guidance directly to product and engineering teams

American Foundation for the Blind

Remote

Researcher (Volunteer)

09/2025 – Present

- Analyzing a **national survey of 1,735 U.S. adults** (1,070 disabled, 665 non-disabled) using a matched-comparison design that isolates disability-specific barriers from general usability friction
- Contributor to **three public reports** on AI and disability spanning transportation access, employment, and cross-cutting risks; findings released through national press coverage and a public policy webinar

Infosys

Remote

Research Scientist Intern, Center for Autonomous Machines

06/2026 – 09/2026

- Led a convergent mixed-methods study, four online focus groups (**n=14**) plus a follow-up survey, producing **design recommendations** emphasizing intentional, multimodal access to designers and developers of autonomous last-mile delivery robots
- Built the study stimulus end-to-end: a browser-based simulation of a pedestrian-robot encounter with screen-reader announcements and reduced-motion support, letting blind and low-vision participants evaluate the scenario without a sighted intermediary
- First author on the resulting technical paper, under submission

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

Champaign, IL

Ph.D. Researcher, (x)Ability Design Lab

05/2024 – Present

- Led a global mixed-methods study of blind and low-vision researchers (**survey n=57, interviews n=15**) using activity theory; surfaced a **17% task-delegation rate** and $\bar{x}=2.58/5$ difficulty ratings for visualization tools, grounding systemic design recommendations across the research workflow for researchers, industry practitioners, and educators
- Ran **8 co-design sessions** (RITE method) to identify barriers in accessible qualitative data visualization, shaping the design of QUARTZ, a qualitative analysis system built using inclusive design principles from the ground up
- Designed survey instruments, semi-structured interview protocols, and task-based usability tests; managed international participant recruitment through BLV advocacy networks including the World Blind Union

- Co-led mixed-methods analysis of a **360-participant** survey on smart-home data consent; found **84%** of users had experienced consent violations, and developed stakeholder-specific recommendations for consentful ecosystems
- Led quantitative analysis of **300M** YouTube influencer advertisements for privacy products, identifying top-advertised categories and consumer misinformation risks

- Designed and implemented a Slack app with 2 other interns using Python (frontend), SQLAlchemy, and Kubernetes (backend) that allows users to manually archive older Jira projects and automatically archive them by a given date

Research Methods & Tools

Qualitative	Co-Design, Semi-Structured Interviews, Focus Groups, Prototyping, Contextual Inquiry, Reflexive Thematic Analysis, Inductive Thematic Analysis, Affinity Diagramming
Quantitative	Survey Design, Statistical Analysis, Experimental Design, A/B Testing, Large-Scale Log and Content Analysis
Evaluative	Moderated Usability Testing, RITE, Heuristic Evaluation, WCAG 2.2 Conformance Auditing
Tools	Python, R, Java, JavaScript, Ollama, Qualtrics, Dovetail, ATLAS.ti, MAXQDA, Figma, SQL, MongoDB, React, D3.js

Selected Publications

- **Omar Khan** and JooYoung Seo. 2026. "I Don't Trust Any Professional Research Tool!": A Re-Imagination of Knowledge Production Workflows by, with, and for Blind and Low-Vision Researchers. *In Proceedings of the 2026 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '26)*. Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, Article 1110, 1–24. [\[Link\]](#)
- **Omar Khan** and JooYoung Seo. 2026. QUARTZ: Qualitative Understanding via Accessible Representation and Visualization. *In The 28th International ACM SIGACCESS Conference on Computers and Accessibility (ASSETS '26)*, October 25–28, 2026, Vila Nova de Gaia, Portugal. ACM, New York, NY, USA, 24 pages. [\[Link\]](#)
- **Omar Khan** and JooYoung Seo. 2026. "I Don't Want My Mental Health App To Give Me Mental (Health) Barriers": Unpacking The Need For Digital Mental Health Tracking Services With And For The Blind Community. *In The 28th International ACM SIGACCESS Conference on Computers and Accessibility (ASSETS '26)*, October 25–28, 2026, Vila Nova de Gaia, Portugal. ACM, New York, NY, USA, 19 pages. [\[Link\]](#)
- Alex Atcheson, **Omar Khan**, Brian Siemann, Anika Jain, and Karrie Karahalios. 2025. "I'd Never Actually Realized How Big An Impact It Had Until Now": Perspectives of University Students with Disabilities on Generative Artificial Intelligence. *In Proceedings of the 2025 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '25)*. Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, Article 42, 1–22. [\[Link\]](#)
- Yi-Shyuan Chiang, **Omar Khan**, Adam Bates, and Camille Cobb. 2024. More than just informed: The importance of consent facets in smart homes. *In Proceedings of the 2024 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '24)*. Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, Article 849, 1–21. [\[Link\]](#)

Service & Recognition

- Vice President, Board of Directors, PACE Center for Independent Living (2026–Present); Director (2023–Present)
- Technical Paper Reviewer, DIS 2026 | SIGACCESS Travel Scholarship, ACM (2025) | CRA-WP Grad Cohort for Women & IDEALS (2025)